

Constitutional Acts & Congress Sessions

Regulating Acts to GOI 1935 plus landmark INC sessions - densest Modern India drill.

Portion focus ~84% · Topic: hist-modern

PYQ themes: Charter/Councils Acts · GOI 1919/1935 · INC sessions · Separate electorates · Dyarchy

Why this portion (PYQ lens)

Portion chance ~84%. Yearly hits; parent hist-modern ~85%.

Years appeared (synthesis): 2016, 2017, 2018, 2019, 2020, 2021, 2022, 2023, 2024, 2025

Why UPSC asks this

Date - provision - personality triples are ideal MCQ machinery.

Syllabus framing

Portion chance ~84%. Yearly hits; parent hist-modern ~85%. This portion sits inside hist-modern and centres on constitutional Acts and INC sessions. Date - provision - personality triples are ideal MCQ machinery.

Recurring PYQ angles: Charter/Councils Acts, GOI 1919/1935, INC sessions, Separate electorates, Dyarchy. Approximate appearance years in the 2016-2025 educational synthesis: 2016, 2017, 2018, 2019, 2020, 2021, 2022, 2023, 2024, 2025. Use the chance percentage only to sequence study hours - it is not an official prediction.

Core map of constitutional Acts and INC sessions

Regulating Act 1773: Parliamentary regulation of Company; GG of Bengal primacy. Pitt's India Act 1784: Dual control / Board of Control narrative.

Charter Act 1833: Centralisation; GG of India; trade monopoly ends. Charter Act 1853: Open competition seed for civil services.

Hold this core map as your elimination spine before memorising peripheral CA overlays.

Core concepts and definitions

GOI Act 1858: Crown rule after 1857. Indian Councils Acts: Gradual Indian association in councils.

Morley - Minto 1909: Separate electorates flashpoint. Montagu - Chelmsford 1919: Dyarchy in provinces.

Institutions, processes and mechanisms

GOI Act 1935: Provincial autonomy; federal scheme partly unimplemented. 1885 Bombay: INC founding.

1907 Surat: Moderates - Extremists split. 1916 Lucknow: Congress - League pact / reunion themes.

India angle and applied examples

1929 Lahore: Purna Swaraj under Nehru. 1931 Karachi: Rights/economic programme resolution themes.

1905 Swadeshi context: Bengal partition political shock. 1920 Nagpur: NCM organisational shifts.

Comparisons, linkages and discriminators

Electorates politics: Communal representation debates from 1909. Federal failure 1935: Princes/ British politics blocked full federation.

Firsts card: Women presidents and other firsts in matching lists. Study spine: One-page Acts + one-page sessions beats clutter.

India angle

Treat Acts as constitutional pre-history; sessions as nationalist calendar.

Question patterns and exam spine

Matching lists and multi-statement questions on constitutional Acts and INC sessions.

Revision spine: Definitions -> table -> India -> traps for constitutional Acts and INC sessions.

Eliminate anachronisms and category errors first, then test remaining options against table rows and must-remember triggers.

Trap watch-list (specific)

Avoid: Purna Swaraj before 1929. Avoid: Mixing 1919 dyarchy with 1935 autonomy. Avoid: 1909 electorates attributed to 1919. Avoid: Assuming 1935 federation fully worked.

Acts spine

Act | Hook

1773 -- GG Bengal

1833 -- GG India

1858 -- Crown

1909 -- Separate electorates

1919 -- Dyarchy

1935 -- Provincial autonomy

Sessions

Year | Hook

1885 -- Founding

1907 -- Surat split

1916 -- Lucknow

1929 -- Purna Swaraj

1931 -- Karachi

Common traps

x Purna Swaraj before 1929

x Mixing 1919 dyarchy with 1935 autonomy

x 1909 electorates attributed to 1919

x Assuming 1935 federation fully worked

Must remember

- 1773/1833/1858/1909/1919/1935
- Surat 1907
- Lucknow 1916
- Lahore 1929

- Dyarchy != autonomy

Quick revision checklist

- [] Reproduce table
- [] 5 must-remembers
- [] 3 traps
- [] India anchor
- [] 10 MCQs

Educational prioritisation heuristic - not an official UPSC prediction. (c) UPSC IAS Study Hub original notes.